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Flex Launcher Configuration File Editor Proposal

For this project I intend to create documentation for a program that will exist for the express purpose of editing a configuration file for my Home Theatre PC. It is a well known fact that programmers are so lazy they will spend 5 hours automating a task that would take them 30 minutes and I am here to prove that by spending a week's worth of work to do what could take me 1 hour.

Background

Flex Launcher is a customizable application launcher and front end designed for use on a home theater PC to mimic the look and feel of a streaming box or game console. While the launcher is easy to run on any PC, the configuration aspect is not handled by the application. Instead, the user is directed to edit the configuration file which is hiding inside a hidden folder inside the user's application files. The configuration file is a ".ini" file which is a standardized plain text settings file.

Proposed Project

For this project I intend to create an application to edit the configuration file. I spent a few minutes creating some boilerplate application code which will work for the program. This program will not integrate with the rest of Flex Launcher, as that program is written in C and let's face it I haven't even finished chapter 1 of my C Programming Language book. Instead of navigating the file browser or terminal to change a few settings in the initial setup of this application, I intend to create a small Java application which can manage the user's config.ini file and also create the documentation for the Java application as an exercise in writing technical documentation. If the final version goes well I will probably spend some time this summer coding it into C so that it might get merged with the original project, however any code written in C is not within the scope of this project.

Schedule & Cost

This project will take place during the length of time that the documentation project is active on ASULearn. The final date this project will be active will be Sunday, March 8, 2026. No hours will be billed, however it will take somewhere between 5-10 hours to complete.

This project will create useful documentation for an application which will benefit one user - myself. In doing so, I will create a framework for a future proposed update to a program in C which I use every day I use my HTPC.